



Precision over power: Beth Mooney's placement-driven approach keeps bowlers guessing. SANDEEP SAXENA

in the air, they lose their shape and perhaps try and hit it too hard and don't get as stable.

"Meg (Lanning) is a good example of someone who can take the game away from you without you really noticing because she plays classical cricket shots and focuses on placement rather than risks. So it gets hard to get her out.

"We have a good balance of both approaches in our line-up. We have a Dottin, Gardner, Bharti (Fulmali)

and Simran (Shaikh). We have people like Phoebe (Litchfield) and me who are more placement-driven, and we might just all end up with the same strike rate, but we just do it a little differently."

Building a culture

Mooney is the last remaining link to the 'Mithali Raj-Rachael Haynes-Nooshin Al Khadeer' think tank that shaped Gujarat Giants in its early years. Now, alongside head coach Michael Klinger, she has been working to build a culture of confidence and transparency.

She credits this culture for GG's spirited chase in its final league

game against Mumbai Indians — a match that, had it gone its way, could have propelled it into the final.

"He gave everyone the confidence to go. Just having a coach and support staff around gave the team that kind of belief that we could do it if we tried. Everyone walked out there feeling like it was their time to win the game for us."

Setting standards

On the field, Mooney holds her teammates to high standards.

"You've got to know when the right time to pull them up on stuff is and when you've got to pat them on the back. There's probably only been one occasion in this tournament where I've had to really rev them up on the field, and they seem to respond really well to that. You don't want to have to use it all the time because it loses its impact."

Yet, she remains a student of the game. A highly competitive Australian cricket ecosystem — and an ever-growing crop of young talents looking to take her spot — keeps her sharp.

"Everyone just wants to get better. Nobody slacks off. Everyone's really fit. They're in the gym, they're running, and they're training hard. No one's got a set spot in the team. It's easy to get better when the people around you are getting better as well."

Stillness in the chaos

For Mooney, maintaining composure is key. After Australia's 2022 ODI World Cup win, she found herself momentarily questioning her next steps.

"We'd won pretty much everything. What do we do now?" she recalls.

She has since learned to navigate these moments of uncertainty by staying grounded — a trait that has helped her deliver in high-pressure situations.

"To be honest, I just think being up and down would be exhausting. When there's a four or a six, everyone's up and cheering, but if there's a wicket, things get pretty